

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Chicken, Pear, and Blue Cheese Salad

with Crispy Shallots and Almonds

Tonight's salad is all about balance. Little gem lettuce is the perfect counterpoint for rich, creamy blue cheese dressing and fried shallots, while roasted and shredded chicken thighs provide satisfying contrast to chunks of juicy d'Anjou pear. Extend that balance from your plate to your glass with the help of our chef-approved wine pairing: floral, dry Finger Lakes Riesling.

45–55 minutes 600 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 8 chicken thighs
- 4 heads little gem lettuce
- 2 d'Anjou pears
- ¼ ounce chives, divided
- 2 shallots
- ¼ cup sliced almonds
- 3 packets sour cream
- 2 tablespoons Champagne vinegar
- 3 ounces crumbled blue cheese, divided

You'll need

canola oil
olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
aluminum foil
baking sheet
6" small pot

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

For the perfect wine pairing, try a Riesling from New York's Finger Lakes region. This highly aromatic wine comes in a range of sweetness levels—we suggest a dry style. Notes of honeysuckle, orange blossom, and green apple help bring out the fresh pear in the salad without overpowering its delicate texture. Meanwhile, the wine's crisp acidity is refreshing against the rich dressing and fried shallots.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

1852-6113-4P



1. Roast chicken thighs

Preheat oven to 450°F. Line a baking sheet with foil. Pat **chicken** dry with paper towel and place on prepared baking sheet. Season all over with **1 teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired, then arrange skin-side up. Roast until skin is crisp and chicken is cooked through and no longer pink, 25–35 minutes.



2. Prepare ingredients

While chicken roasts, halve **little gem** lengthwise, rinse thoroughly, and pat dry with paper towel. Tear **leaves** into bite-size pieces, discarding tough stems. Rinse remaining produce. Slice off rounded sides of **pears**, discarding cores, and cut into ½-inch pieces. Thinly slice **chives**. Peel **shallots** and thinly slice into rings; then, using your fingers, gently separate **shallot rings**.



3. Toast almonds

Place **almonds** in a small pot over medium-high heat. Toast, stirring frequently, until golden brown and fragrant, 3–5 minutes. Remove pot from heat. Transfer **almonds** to a bowl and set aside for serving. Wipe pot clean for the next step.



4. Fry shallots

Return pot from almonds to medium-high heat with **3 tablespoons canola oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **1 shallot ring** to pot. If it sizzles immediately, keep going; if not, try again once the oil is hotter. Fry all **shallot rings**, stirring to prevent burning, until lightly browned and crisp, about 5 minutes. Remove pot from heat. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **crispy shallots** to a paper towel–lined plate to drain.



5. Make dressing and shred chicken

In a large bowl, whisk together **sour cream**, **Champagne vinegar**, **half of blue cheese**, **half of chives**, **3½ tablespoons olive oil**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired to combine. Remove and discard skin from **chicken** (it helped keep the meat moist as it cooked, but could create a chewier texture in your salad, so we recommend removing it), then shred using 2 forks or roughly chop, discarding bones.



6. Plate chicken, pear, and blue cheese salad

To bowl with blue cheese dressing, add **shredded chicken** and **little gem**; toss to coat, then divide **salad** among serving plates. Top with **pears**, **toasted almonds**, **crispy shallots**, **remaining chives**, and **remaining blue cheese**. Open up a bottle of wine (see recipe tip), and dig in!

Join the Plated community
and post your #platedpics!